

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 30)

- 2.1. 2 for each correct answer. (max 10)
- 2.2. 1 for each correct word-part (marked here by +). (max 20)
- Insist on correct accents and dotted letters

2.1.a	50	2.2.a	è+ji+lá (3)
b	85	b	àá+do+run (3)
c	75	c	ẹ+ẹtà+dilo+gó+ta (5)
d	103	d	à+rùn+do+gó+ji (5)
e	39	e	òkán+dilo+gó+run (4)

Commentary

Yoruba's counting system is based on 20s, with counting back: the numbers 6,7,8,9 are expressed as 4,3,2,1 before the next ten. 30,50,70,90 are expressed as 10 before the next 20.

In addition, the basic numbers undergo some tone pattern changes.

	Base number	Counting back +dil	Counting forward +d	X20 ogó-
1	<i>not shown</i>	òkán	<i>not shown</i>	ogun * (20)
2	èji	eéjì	èjì	ji (40)
3	èta	eẹ̀tà	ètà	ta (60)
4	èrin	eẹ̀rìn	èrìn	rin (80)
5	àrun	aárùn	àrùn	run (100)
Tone pattern	` -	V' `	` `	ogó -

Teens are expressed by adding lá to the base number. They are not shown here but there *are* base numbers for 6,7,8,9, only used as units. Odd 20s are expressed by àádo '10 off'.

The base form of 1 and the form for counting forward, eg 21, 31, do not follow the same tone pattern, and so are not used here. * Likewise 20 'ogun' is not fully regular. But since 20 is a special value, this is not surprising.

So the given data can be glossed as follows:

èji 2

èrin 4

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àrun	5	
ẹrinlá	14	4 teen
eẹ̀jìdilogun	18	2 before 20
ẹẹ̀rìndilogóji	36	4 before 20x2
ẹ̀rìndogóji	44	4 + 20x2
àádorin	70	10 off 4(score)
ẹẹ̀tádilogórin	77	3 before 20x4
ẹ̀tádogórin	83	3 + 20x4

A1. Write the following Yoruba numbers in figures

a. àádota	50	10 off 3(score)
b. àrúndogórin	85	5 + 4x20
c. aárùndilogórin	75	5 before 4x20
d. ẹ̀tádogórun	103	3 + 5x20
e. òkándilogóji	39	1 before 20x2

Note: òkán has not been seen in the data but if you realise there are only words for 1-5 because of the counting back system, it must be 1: we've seen 2,3,4,5.